THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

For families deciding which camps to pay for. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.

For families deciding which camps to pay for. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot, playing time or income. Confirm every rule with each school's compliance office. `TO VERIFY` = not confirmed against a primary source on 2026-11-05.

CONTENTS

1. Camp types
2. Camp rules every family should know
3. When recruiting talk opens at a camp, by sport
4. Budget
5. Post-camp follow-up
6. Trackers
7. Sources

1. CAMP TYPES

- **College's own camp:** run by the school or its athletics staff (D1 Bylaw 13.12.1.1).
- **Showcase / third-party event:** run by a company; many colleges attend.
- **Prospect camp vs instructional camp:** prospect camps are evaluations in practice; the bylaw treats both as camps.

2. RULES EVERY FAMILY SHOULD KNOW

- A D1 school's camp must be open to any and all entrants, limited only by number, age, grade or gender (Bylaw 13.12.1.3), and advertised publicly at least 14 days before it starts (Bylaw 13.12.1.6).
- Staff working the camp generally can't recruit you during it, including written aid offers (Bylaw 13.12.1.5), except where the sport-specific exceptions below allow.
- No camp in a dead period or recruiting shutdown (Bylaw 13.12.1.5).

3. WHEN RECRUITING TALK OPENS AT A D1 CAMP

SPORT	OPENS	RULE
Most sports (not those below)	Aug 1, junior year	13.12.1.5.1 (rev. 10/7/26)
Baseball, women's lacrosse	Sept 1, junior year (12 p.m. ET for WLAX)	13.12.1.5.2 (rev. 6/29/26 eff. 8/1/26)
Men's lacrosse	Wednesday 7 a.m. after Labor Day, junior year	13.12.1.5.3 (adopted 6/29/26 eff. 8/1/26)
Softball	1 p.m. CT Sept 1, junior year	13.12.1.5.4 (adopted 6/24/26)
Men's basketball	Permitted for staff employed at the camp	13.12.1.5.5
Football (FBS/FCS)	Permitted for staff employed at the camp	13.12.1.5.6
Men's ice hockey, women's basketball, wrestling	Sport-specific rules	`TO VERIFY` in 13.12.1.5.7+

Before that date, a camp is still a chance to be seen. It's just not a conversation.

4. BUDGET

Set a season cap first. Cost = fee + travel + lodging + missed work. Score every camp before paying (sheet below). A camp at a school that isn't on your target list scores low.

5. POST-CAMP FOLLOW-UP (WITHIN 72 HOURS, RECOMMENDED)

> Coach [Last name], thank you for [camp, date]. I was the [position], #[number]. I worked on [drill] and would like to know what you'd want me to improve. Film: [link]. [Name], Class of [year].

Only send after your sport's message date (see the *Highlight Reel* playbook, section 6).

6. TRACKERS

Camp scoring (1-5 each)

CAMP	ON MY TARGET LIST?	STAFF FOR MY POSITION PRESENT?	LEVEL FIT	RECRUITING TALK ALLOWED AT MY AGE?	COST	SCORE

Budget

CAMP	FEE	TRAVEL	LODGING	TOTAL	RUNNING TOTAL VS CAP

7. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA D1 Manual, LSDBi 90008, checked 2026-11-05: Bylaws 13.12.1.1, 13.12.1.3, 13.12.1.5, 13.12.1.5.1-13.12.1.5.6, 13.12.1.6.